THE AI ADVANTAGE

From asking questions to solving real problems in your role — today.

QUICK QUESTION:

Which AI tools are you currently using?

A ChatGPT

B Claude

C Gemini / Copilot

D None yet

Type your answer in the chat →

QUICK QUESTION:

Where are you at with AI right now?

A Haven't started — not sure where to begin

B Tried it a few times, mixed results

C Using it regularly but want to get more from it

D Already getting strong results

Type your answer in the chat →

LAST ONE:

What are you mainly using AI for today?

A Writing — emails, reports, communications

B Research and finding information

C Solving operational problems in my role

D I'm not using it yet

Type your answer in the chat →

HERE'S WHAT I KEEP SEEING.

People are using AI like a search engine.
And wondering why they're getting search engine results.

The problem isn't the tool. It's the approach.

1. Ask a question. Get an answer. Move on.
2. Get frustrated when the answer isn't quite right.
3. Decide the tool doesn't work for them.

THIS IS WHAT MOST PEOPLE DO.

AI

How do I improve my team's compliance tracking?

Here are some strategies to improve compliance tracking:

1. Implement a digital compliance management system
2. Create standardised checklists for each compliance area
3. Set up automated reminders for certificate renewals
4. Conduct regular compliance audits
5. Provide training sessions for staff...

Generic. Could apply to any business. Misses the actual problem entirely.

SAME PROBLEM. DIFFERENT OUTCOME.

AI

I'm an office manager at a trades business — 25 staff, subcontractors in and out. Compliance is a constant headache. Before you suggest anything, ask me questions one at a time until you understand what's actually going wrong.

Before I suggest anything, I want to make sure I understand what's actually happening.

First question: when compliance paperwork falls through the cracks, what's the most common reason? Is it that nobody owns it, the tracking system fails, or something else?

Specific. Contextual. Already finding the real problem.

BEFORE YOU THINK ABOUT THE SOLUTION —

Get clarity on the problem.

✗ Most people do this

Open AI. Describe a solution. Ask AI to help build it.

They get a mediocre answer to the wrong question.

→ What actually works

Describe the problem first. Don't mention a solution. Let the conversation surface what's really going on.

✓ Why it matters

The quality of your output is determined before you type the first prompt. Clarity is the work.

" When you give yourself time to go deep with AI — the results are 10x. "

THE COMPLETE SYSTEM

Three phases. Used in order. Every time.

PHASE 1

UNPACK THE PROBLEM

5-Layer Model

Map your problem clearly before you ask for anything.
Know what you're actually solving.

PHASE 2

WORK WITH AI

The C^3 Method

Clarity · Curiosity · Challenge
The conversation that builds the real answer.

PHASE 3

GO DEEPER

The DEEPER Framework

Discover · **E**xplore · **E**valuate
Plan · **E**xecute · **R**efine

Six steps that compound every time.

DISCOVER
Find the real problem

EXPLORE
Work with AI

EVALUATE
Challenge the output

PLAN
Implementation steps

EXECUTE
Build it

REFINE
Improve and repeat

MEET SARAH.

Her role: Office manager. Trades business. 25 staff, subcontractors rotating in and out.

Her problem: Compliance. Certificates expiring. Inductions not logged. The same spreadsheet nobody trusts.

Her week: Every Monday morning — two hours — before she's started anything else. Three years running.

Her attempts: Sarah tried to fix it twice. Both times it got complicated. Both times she went back to the spreadsheet.

We're going to watch the entire system work — on her problem.

PHASE 1: THE 5-LAYER MODEL

Map the problem before you jump to solutions — on paper or with AI. The breakthrough always happens at Layer 3.

1	**SYMPTOM**	What you notice and complain about.
2	**PROCESS**	What's happening step by step.
3	**CONSTRAINT**	Where it breaks down — and why.
4	**COST**	Time, money, or risk of not solving it.
5	**OWNER**	Who has the problem and why it hasn't been solved.

The test: "If this was solved — what would actually change?" If the answer is vague, you're still at the symptom.

THIS IS WHERE YOU START.

This is the prompt Sarah used to begin. Watch how it works — then use it on your own problem at the end.

MASTER PROMPT -- copy and paste into AI

```
I want to unpack a problem in my business. Don't suggest solutions yet.

Work through these 5 layers with me, one at a time. Ask me ONE question per layer, wait for my
answer, then move to the next. After all 5, restate the real problem in 2 sentences I would agree are
exactly right.

Layer 1 - SYMPTOM:     Ask me what problem I keep running into and who it affects.
Layer 2 - PROCESS:     Ask me to describe what actually happens, step by step.
Layer 3 - CONSTRAINT:  Ask me where it breaks down and why it keeps happening.
Layer 4 - COST:        Ask me what it costs in time, money or risk -- be specific.
Layer 5 - OWNER:       Ask me who should own this and why it hasn't been fixed yet.

Start with Layer 1 now.
```

Watch what happens when Sarah uses this — then you'll use it on your own problem at the end of the session.

SARAH WORKS THROUGH THE 5 LAYERS.

AI walks her through each layer — one question at a time. Watch what shifts.

1	SYMPTOM	*"Compliance paperwork is eating my Monday mornings."*
2	PROCESS	*"Certificates tracked in a spreadsheet. Inductions logged manually. Expiries not flagged anywhere."*
3	CONSTRAINT ★	***"No single owner. Whoever is around does it. Records live in three different places."***
4	COST	*"2 hours every Monday. Two near-misses last year. If we get audited this month — we fail."*
5	OWNER	*"Technically me — but the solution needs to run without me chasing it every week."*

The breakthrough: "The problem isn't the spreadsheet. It's ownership — and the solution can't rely on anyone's memory or bandwidth."

Sarah now knows exactly what she's solving. She's ready to take it into Phase 2.

PHASE 2: THE C³ METHOD

Three moves. Used together, they produce results neither you nor the AI would reach alone.

CLARITY

Know your problem deeply

Load the context. Your role, the bottleneck, the process step by step, the tools you use, the cost of not fixing it. The output quality is set here.

CURIOSITY

Tic-tac, don't dictate

Don't fire solutions at AI. Instead: 'Before you suggest anything, ask me questions one at a time.' Let it pull your thinking out. Less input, more exploration.

CHALLENGE

Stress-test, don't settle

Push back on the first answer. 'Rate this out of 10. Explain why. Now make it a 10.' The real gold is in the third or fourth exchange — not the first.

C^3: THE AI MULTIPLIER

WHAT EACH COMBINATION GIVES YOU

CLARITY + CURIOSITY

Smart Conversation

You understand the problem and explore it well. Solid result.

But without Challenge...

You accept the first answer. You get a good start — not a breakthrough.

CURIOSITY + CHALLENGE

Creative Thinking

You're exploring ideas and pushing boundaries. Lots of energy.

But without Clarity...

You go deep on the wrong thing. Lots of effort, wrong direction.

CLARITY + CHALLENGE

Focused Execution

You know what you want and you're demanding quality.

But without Curiosity...

You only get what you already knew to ask for. Limited by what you know.

All three together = 10x Solutions. That's what we're building today.

THE PHRASES THAT CHANGE THE CONVERSATION.

Screenshot this. You'll use these in the next 20 minutes — and every session after.

C¹ CLARITY

Load the context

- "I'm a [role]. Here's my problem..."
- "Here's the current process step by step..."
- "The bottleneck is..."
- "The tools we already use are..."

C² CURIOSITY

Let AI investigate

- **"Before answering, ask me questions one at a time"**
- "What am I not thinking about?"
- "What would an expert do differently?"
- "Give me 3 options and explain the trade-offs"

C³ CHALLENGE

Push back — don't settle

- "What are the risks or edge cases?"
- "Rate this out of 10. Explain why. Make it a 10."
- "What would you change if starting from scratch?"
- "Poke holes in this. What's missing?"

The starred phrase is the most important one in this session: **"Before answering, ask me questions one at a time."**

NOW TAKE IT INTO PHASE 2.

You don't need to remember everything. Ask AI to do that for you.

PHASE 2 PROMPT -- send this immediately after Phase 1

```
Good. Before you suggest any solutions —

Summarise back to me what you've understood about my problem so far.

Then ask me anything you're still not sure about, one question at a time.

Once you feel confident you understand it — restate the real problem in 2 sentences I'd agree
are exactly right.

Only then ask me if you can start suggesting solutions.
```

AI now does the remembering. Sarah just says yes or no — and the conversation deepens.

"Before you suggest anything, ask me questions one at a time."

Copy this. Use it at the start of every important AI conversation.

This one shift — from answering to questioning — is where most people unlock 10x results.

C¹ CLARITY

AI has summarised the problem. Sarah confirms — and loads the full context to sharpen the conversation.

AI

Role + business context

Constraint named upfront — not the symptom

Curiosity trigger — Sarah hands control to AI

I'm an office manager at a trades business — 25 staff, subcontractors in and out.

Compliance is a constant headache. No single owner, records in three places, certificates expire without warning.

Before you suggest anything, ask me questions one at a time until you understand what's actually going wrong.

Sarah didn't start with a question. She started with context. The quality of what AI asks next depends entirely on the quality of what she loaded here.

C² CURIOSITY

AI leads. Sarah doesn't jump to solutions — she answers.

AI

Before I suggest anything — when a certificate lapses without anyone catching it, what actually happens? Does the worker stop? Does a supervisor step in? Or does it quietly slip through?

Honestly? It slips through. We've had two subcontractors on site with expired white cards in the last six months. We didn't know until an audit.

That's important. Second question: when someone is responsible for checking certificates, who is it — and do they have a reliable way to see expiry dates, or are they manually checking each person?

AI is building a picture — not generating solutions. Each question goes one level deeper than the last.

AI GIVES AN ANSWER.

It sounds right. Most people would stop here.

AI

Based on what you've told me, here's what I'd recommend:

1. Create a shared Google Sheet with all certificates and expiry dates, colour-coded by status.
2. Set up a Google Calendar with recurring alerts 30 days before each expiry.
3. Assign one person per team as the 'compliance owner' responsible for keeping it updated.
4. Review the sheet in your Monday morning meeting.

Plausible.

But misses the real problem.

Sarah knows this.

This is confident. It is not correct. If Sarah doesn't know her business — she accepts it. If she does — she pushes back.

C³ CHALLENGE

Sarah knows her business. AI doesn't. She uses that.

AI

We've tried the Google Sheet twice. It works for a month, then nobody maintains it. The problem isn't the tool — it's that compliance gets deprioritised the moment anyone is busy. What am I not thinking about?

That's a critical distinction — thank you for pushing back.

If manual maintenance always fails under pressure, the system can't rely on human remembering. Let me ask differently: **is there a point in your existing workflow — onboarding, site sign-in, invoicing — where compliance status is already checked? Because the answer is to embed it there, not add a separate process.**

Sarah said 'What am I not thinking about?' — and AI changed direction entirely. That's Challenge working.

AI RESTATES THE PROBLEM.

Sarah says: "That's exactly it." The real solution can now begin.

AI

Let me restate what I'm actually hearing:

The real problem is that compliance checking only happens when someone remembers — and under pressure, nobody does. A new tool won't fix that. What's needed is compliance status that's visible automatically at a trigger point that already exists in your workflow, so it doesn't depend on anyone's memory or bandwidth.

Yes. That's exactly it. That's what I've been trying to say for three years.

The conversation has done its job. Now AI designs the solution — for the real problem, not the labelled one.

WHAT AI PRODUCED

Not what Sarah asked for — what she actually needed.

SHE ASKED FOR	SHE NEEDED	SHE GOT
A better checklist. Something to replace the spreadsheet that kept breaking down.	A system that doesn't depend on anyone remembering. Compliance visible automatically at an existing trigger point.	Compliance status embedded into site sign-in — checked automatically on arrival, not by memory. No new process. No new maintenance burden. It runs on what already exists.

The C^3 method — Clarity, Curiosity, Challenge — is what made the gap between columns 1 and 3 possible.

NOW MAKE THE PLAN.

C^3 ends with an agreed solution. This prompt turns it into steps you can actually execute.

PLAN PROMPT -- send this once the solution is agreed

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Good. We've agreed on the solution.

Now help me build a step-by-step implementation plan.

Give me:
1. The agreed solution in one sentence.
2. The steps to implement it — in order, with who does what.
3. What done looks like — specific and measurable in 30 days.
4. The first action I can take this week.

Keep it practical. I need to be able to hand this to someone on Monday.
```

AI has all the context from the conversation. It does the work — you just confirm it's right.

PHASE 3: GO DEEPER.

Six steps. The framework that turns a conversation into a result — and compounds every time you use it.

DISCOVER

Find the real problem

5-Layer Model.
Surface what's
actually going on.

SARAH

Problem isn't the spreadsheet — it's ownership.

EXPLORE

Work with AI

$C^1 + C^2$.
Load context.
Let AI question.

SARAH

AI asked 2 questions. Surfaced near-misses Sarah hadn't counted.

EVALUATE

Challenge the output

C^3.
Push back.
Agree the solution.

SARAH

Sarah pushed back on the Google Sheet. AI changed direction.

PLAN

Implementation steps

Plan prompt.
AI generates
steps from solution.

SARAH

AI produced a step-by-step. Sarah confirmed it on Friday.

EXECUTE

Build it

One more session.
Built Thursday.
Running Monday.

SARAH

Compliance embedded in site sign-in. Zero manual checks.

REFINE

Improve and repeat

What worked?
What to improve?
Go again.

SARAH

Month 1: AI Project.
Month 3: live web tool.

SARAH SENDS THE PLAN PROMPT.

AI generates the implementation plan from the conversation. Sarah doesn't have to remember anything.

AI

Based on everything we've discussed, here's your implementation plan:

Solution: Compliance status embedded into site sign-in — automatic, no manual follow-up.

Steps:
1. Map existing sign-in workflow with IT — identify the trigger point. *Owner: Sarah + IT lead. Week 1.*
2. Connect certificate database to sign-in system. *Owner: IT. Weeks 2-3.*
3. Test with 3 subcontractors before full rollout. *Owner: Sarah. Week 4.*

Done when: Zero manual certificate checks on Monday mornings. System flags expiries automatically.

First action this week: Book 30 minutes with IT lead. Show them this plan.

Sarah didn't write this. AI did — from the conversation. She just said: "Yes. Book the meeting."

SARAH'S IMPLEMENTATION PLAN.

Generated by AI from the conversation. Confirmed by Sarah in two minutes.

THE SOLUTION

Agreed solution — in one sentence

Compliance status checked automatically at site sign-in. If a certificate is expired or missing — the worker cannot complete sign-in. No manual checking required.

THE STEPS

In order — with owners and timelines

Step 1: Map existing sign-in workflow with IT. Identify the trigger point. Owner: Sarah + IT lead. Week 1.
Step 2: Connect certificate database to sign-in system. Owner: IT. Weeks 2–3.
Step 3: Pilot with 3 subcontractors before full rollout. Owner: Sarah. Week 4.

DONE WHEN

Specific and measurable — she can check this on a Monday

Zero manual certificate checks on Monday mornings. System flags expiries automatically. Zero near-misses on site.

FIRST ACTION THIS WEEK

One action — this week — not 'look into it'

Book 30 minutes with IT lead. Share this plan. Get a start date.

This is what the P in DEEPER produces. **A plan you can hand to someone on Monday.**

EXECUTE. THEN REFINE.

One more AI session to build it. Then the loop starts again — deeper each time.

Execute

- ✓ One more AI session on Thursday to build the sign-in integration.
- ✓ Tested with 3 subcontractors before full rollout.
- ✓ Running by Monday morning.

→

Refine

Month 1

Sarah creates an AI Project — subcontractor rules, certificate types, her voice.

Month 3

Her compliance tracker becomes a live web tool. Expiry alerts automated.

Same method. Deeper each time.

Monday mornings: 2 hours → 20 minutes.

Three years. Same problem. Fixed in one session.

Beginner.

The DEEPER framework works on every problem. **The only question is what you go deeper on next.**

WHAT'S YOUR VERSION OF SARAH'S MONDAY MORNING?

Pick one thing. Real. Specific. Yours.

- Takes too long
- Is repetitive
- Frustrates you
- You suspect could be done better

Use the starter prompt from S20. Clarity → Curiosity → Challenge.

WHERE THIS GETS YOU

WEEK 1	You change how you prompt. The output quality doubles immediately. One phrase does it.
MONTH 1	You've solved two or three problems that have been sitting on your list. Real tools. Real time saved.
MONTH 3	You're building things that used to cost $100k and take six months. In an afternoon.

When you give yourself time to go deep with AI — the results are 10x.

THREE LEVELS. ONE METHOD.

The DEEPER framework works at every level. The R — Refine — is what makes the ceiling keep rising.

BEGINNER

START HERE

WHO

Haven't started, or tried and got mixed results.

WHAT

One good prompt. One good conversation. A real problem solved.

EXAMPLE

Sarah: 2 hours of Monday compliance work → 20 minutes.

TOOLS

Claude.ai · The C^3 starter prompt

INTERMEDIATE

NEXT LEVEL

WHO

Using it regularly. Want more from it.

WHAT

AI knows your business. Tools built. Sessions chained. Connected to your software.

EXAMPLE

A quoting calculator. A compliance tracker. A proposal writer that knows your voice.

TOOLS

Claude Projects · Claude Code · Zapier / Make

ADVANCED

THE CEILING

WHO

Already getting results. Ready to compound.

WHAT

AI that knows your whole business context and works proactively — not just when you ask.

EXAMPLE

A system that surfaces problems before you see them. Workflows that run without you.

TOOLS

Claude Projects · Agents · Custom integrations

WHERE DO YOU GO FROM HERE?

Find your level. Pick your next move.

BEGINNER

Haven't started, or tried and got mixed results

→ Use the C³ starter prompt on one real problem this week.

One good conversation · One problem solved · One process improved

Claude.ai

INTERMEDIATE

Using AI regularly, want more consistent and deeper results

→ Create an AI Project for your role. Give it context about your business, your clients, your voice.

Proposal writer that sounds like you · Quoting tool · Compliance tracker · Zapier automations

Claude Projects · Claude Code · Zapier / Make

ADVANCED

AI is already working in your business — you want it to compound

→ Build AI that knows your whole business context and surfaces problems before you see them.

Custom internal tools · Automated reporting · Workflows that run without you

Claude Projects + memory · Claude Code + Supabase · Custom agents

Wherever you are — the next level uses the same method. Just more context, more connection, more compounding.

> *The person who knows the job will always beat the person who knows the tech. You know the job. Now you've got the multiplier.*

You've already started. Keep going.